Research proposal on

Music on online platforms: how musicians can emphasize Bangladeshi audiences to buy songs

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Spring 2021

Section: 1

Table of Contents

1.0 Introduction **2**

1.1 Focus area **2**

1.2 Context **3**

1.3 Topic Relevance **3**

1.4 Research Objectives **4**

1.5 Questions that this research will answer **4**

1.6 Scopes and Limitations **4**

2.0 Literature Review **5**

3.0 Research Design **8**

3.1 Research Methodology **8**

3.2 Sampling **8**

3.3 Timeframe 9

3.4 Budgeting 9

References **10**

<u>Title:</u> Music on online platforms; how musicians can emphasize Bangladeshi audiences to buy songs.

1.0 Introduction

1.1 Focus area

In recent times some online music platforms such as Spotify,Gaana,Gpmusic etcetera have started their business in our country. These platforms offer a huge number of music from all over the world and in return they charge some money from the audiences. It is a monthly or yearly based subscription system to listen to music. But as youtube is too available now and it is free,Bangladeshi audiences mainly depend on Youtube for listening to music and this is why they are not that much interested to pay for the subscription to the streaming sites.

The Focus of this research will be on a contextual analysis of how the musicians of our country can inspire and emphasize the audiences to start using these online platforms which will help the musicians to earn money by producing songs.

1.2 Context

When it comes to listening to music on the internet, the Music Industry Blog recently published a report looking at the differences between streaming services like Spotify and YouTube, focusing on how many people use each. While 37% of customers utilize streaming music services, 55% of customers watch YouTube videos on a regular basis. In our country, the ratio of YouTube users to those who use other online platforms is much lower. Our folks have no intention of purchasing music from the streaming companies.

In this matter,the musicians of our country are facing losses by producing music. As the music tastes of all the audiences are not the same,musicians of some popular genres such as pop,rock,jazz etcetera are not getting proper attention to their music on Youtube. They gain fewer views than the commercial music of our country and this is why they do not get paid properly from the “view count system” of Youtube. For example one of the most popular bands of our country “Warfaze” has only 103K subscribers whereas the most successful commercial music company “G series” has 6.7M subscribers in their Youtube channel. This clearly shows the discrimination between the band music and the commercial music.

1.3 Topic Relevance

Even as a child, I enjoyed listening to music and, in sixth grade, began learning how to play the guitar. After S.S.C., I took up drumming and joined a band with some of my classmates. We had high expectations and hoped to make this our sole source of income because we were all so passionate about music. However, our parents, elders, relatives, and even some friends discouraged us from pursuing music as a career because the outlook in our country is bleak. We persisted in our efforts, but as time passed, we came to the realization that pursuing a career in music is really difficult. I was taken aback and set out to discover why this had happened. In this sense, the subject pertains to my personal experience.

The goal of this study is to identify measures that senior artists in the country can take to combat audio piracy, which will allow them to receive proper honoraria for their work and encourage the next generation to pursue music as a profession.

1.4 Research Objectives

The objectives of this study are as follows:

1. To find out the main reasons for audio piracy.
2. To find out some steps which can be taken by the musicians to stop piracy.
3. To point out the importance of online streaming platforms in our music industry.
4. To find out what the musicians can do to make the audiences inspired to use these platforms.

1.5 Questions that this research will answer

1. What is piracy and why does this happen?
2. How audio piracy is harmful for the industry?
3. What steps should be taken by the musicians to stop piracy?
4. How online streaming platforms can help to stop audio piracy?
5. Why are the audiences not interested in using these platforms?
6. What are the ways to make the audiences pay for the music they want to listen to?

1.6 Scopes and Limitations

Scopes:

1. The findings of this research may help the industry to lessen audio piracy.
2. This may prevent the musicians from being hopeless to produce music and so they can earn some money due to their hard work.

3. Also this will hopefully help the young musicians to be inspired to come to the industry so that the pipeline for the future becomes strong

Limitations:

1. The commercial music agencies may try to fail the musicians because these online platforms can be harmful for their business.
2. As this may be a long term campaign,if the percentage of the online platform users does not grow in a proper ratio,the online stream launchers may stop their business in our country.

2.0 Literature Review

This section highlights the literature that served as a foundation for the study's background and essential themes, and as a map for charting its course.

2.1 Title - ***"Digital music and online sharing: software piracy 2.0?" (2003)***

In this article **Sudip Bhattacharjee**, **Ram D. Gopal**, **G. Lawrence Sanders** proved that rapid advancements in internet access and digital compression technology have resulted in a major increase in online sharing of digitized content, resulting in intellectual property rights conflicts and lost sales. For instance, internet music sharing has resulted in legal challenges and industry alliances, as well as grave concerns about the industry's long-term future.

Methodology: The researchers conjured the theory based on both **qualitative and quantitative** primary research. First they analyzed the reasons why the audiences are becoming interested in listening to music in the digital way. Despite the analogue process of listening to music being the only way to get the original and high definition version of the song, they tried to point out why the audiences are willing to listen to the digital version found from the internet. Then they ran a survey on over 200 people to find out how many of them are listening to songs from the analogue way and the digital way.

Findings: Their study showed that as the rapid growth of internet availability this digital process of music sharing has become a vital reason for happening audio piracy. They pointed out that money is one of the most vital issues of this,as the digital way of sharing is the cheapest way to collect music,whereas the analogue and manual process was too expensive for some audiences.

2.2 Title - "*Music in the Digital Age: The Emergence of Digital Music and Its Repercussions on the Music Industry" (2010)*

In this paper **Sadie A. Stafford** tried to find out how record companies, artists, music publishers and consumers need to welcome new technology and enable the digital age to work in their favor with the hope that the great art form "music" will maintain its purity for all time.

Methodology: The methodology of this research focused only on **qualitative** analysis. The researcher first discussed what is the main reason for the audiences' increasing interest in digital music and then he proved that everything in this music industry will be digitalized day by day. He gave the readers a tour to how this process will happen and then he proved that all the analogue process of sharing music will be lost. So he found out some ways how record companies, artists and music publishers should produce and spread their music now,so that they can make income out of their production as they did by selling music in analogue systems.

Next he feared that this digitalization can also be harmful for the industry as it can cause audio piracy as downloaded versions of the song can easily be shared through the internet and the audiences can download them for free. He pointed out the reasons and processes of this happening.

Findings: To conclude the researcher said that record companies, artists, music publishers and the audiences should embrace the digital medium of music sharing and only their honesty can save music and it's industry from audio piracy. He named this segment as "The Digital Epidemic" as he pointed out that this piracy can cause great loss to the musicians that may demotivate them to create music for the industry.

Title - "*Independent Music Artists in a Digital World" (2017)*

Ryan Sheehan's research sought to determine how independent and minor label musicians might effectively advertise their music and themselves using the internet and social media. According to this paper, the music industry comprises a variety of various components, including music streaming (and how it works), the distinctions between working for a record label and going it alone as an artist, and musicians who have achieved success independently of a record label.

Methodology: His methodology was a **qualitative** method of analysis. In this study he critically analyzed how the musicians all over the world became independent in their music business in acquaintance with the increase of internet availability. His research was totally based on the researcher's self analysis on the continuous changes of the music industry and the musicians. He showed how the online music distribution system made them independent and how they themselves could be their own promoter by using the digital medium.

Findings: Ryan Sheehan proved that the music industry has evolved significantly since its inception. The techniques for creating, distributing, and selling music have all shifted, with the internet and social media being two of the key drivers of this change. He said Due to technology advancements, there is an abundance of music available today, allowing anyone with internet access to listen to music from all over the world, in any style or genre, at any time they want. Many musicians, particularly those without the backing of a record label, struggle to make a living. While small and independent artists may lack the financial means necessary to compete with major label bands, the Internet and social media have enabled them to level the playing field. Understanding the music industry, including streaming, royalties, copyright, and other marketing and branding techniques, can aid independent musicians in their pursuit of success.

2.4 Title - "*Can music streaming services become a saving grace for Bangladesh's band scene?" (2021)*

This is the most relevant article that we could find to the topic of our research. Two Bangladeshi researchers **Ahmmed Madhurja** and **Soumik Siddique** tried to find out if music streaming services can bring some positive aspects to Bangladeshi band music as numerous challenges plaguing Bangladesh's band music industry, including as revenue sharing and audience access, could be resolved by music streaming platforms.

Methodology: The researchers followed **qualitative** research methods in this research to find out the positive sides of online streaming services for the band music of our country. They analyzed the history of our local band music from the beginning and then they studied how the musicians used to distribute their music in the past via the analogue mediums such as cassettes,CDs etcetera. Then they showed how this analogue process turned into the digital way and how it affected the band music of our country. Then they threw a discussion on the online

music streaming platforms which were introduced recently to our music industry. They tried to find out the good sides of this which can be helpful for the musicians to continue doing band music in this country.

Findings: The researchers pointed out various positive aspects of online music platforms,such as if the audiences start to listen to music through these platforms,the musicians will be properly paid for their creation,as the streaming companies have to pay the musicians due to their royalty. Again,the young generation who are interested in music career will find a platform to promote their new songs that will help them to be popular to the audiences, Thus the band music industry will be able to find it's lost glory again and it will represent our culture to the outer world

3.0 Research Design

3.1 Research Methodology

a. Both **qualitative and quantitative** research methods will be required in unison to determine the outcome of the research.The qualitative data will show why the audiences are not that much interested in subscribing to the online platforms. Then the quantitative data will show how many people are using these streaming platforms and which genres are mostly followed on these platforms. This will help us to detect the musicians of those genres and talk to them about our research.
b. A short **survey** will be conducted to find out the numbers of the audiences and their process of music collecting. Then we will analyze the data adieu to some proposed criteria that will help us to find out the main reasons behind this scarcity of online platform subscribers.
c. We will create a **questionnaire** module consisting of 20-30 questions for the audiences which will help us to determine the main reasons for their less interest in using the online platforms. The questions will be created from some basics to some common arguments.
d. Then another module which will have 15-20 questions will be prepared for an **interview** with both the renowned and the newest musicians of our country on the basis of the outcome of the questionnaire session with the audiences. We will prepare the questions after critically studying the audience response and then our interview will get started.

Then it will turn into a **focus group discussion** which we will arrange with all the musicians from the interviews and will try to find out the solutions of the issue togetherly.

3.2 Sampling

1. Stratified Sampling (systematic random sampling): Questionnaire

Since the study is on the Bangladeshi music industry,all the audiences will be from Bangladesh as well. As we will be provided with a limited timeframe and budget,a population cap of 5000 samples will be used and will be divided into genders-male female and some different age groups such as 10-20,20-30,30-40 and 40-50. Among them the subgroup will be created as:

1. School going both male and female audiences (both english medium and bangla medium-20%
2. University studying audiences both male and female-20%
3. Working male audiences-20%
4. Working female audiences-20%
5. Non working male and female audiences-20%

We can achieve a maximum and sufficient output with this sampling strategy since each stratum member has an equal likelihood of being chosen and engaging in the survey.

2. Purposive Sampling (Non-probability sampling): Interview and Focus Group Discussion

These samples will be selected on the basis of their musical career in the industry,half of them will be successful and renowned musicians who are involved in the production for a long time. The other half will also be the musicians but they will be the newcomers who are willing to enter into the music industry and have started creating music as well. We will need 10 members from each criterias. The musicians will be of different genres so that all kinds of music will be covered to discuss. As the data will have been pre collected the group will discuss the reasons of the less interest of the audience in using online streaming platforms and then they together will try to find out the solutions to the problem

3.3 Timeframe

Content Analysis	This will take not more than two weeks to analyze the contents on the music streaming platforms.

Survey	Now to conduct the survey on the data of online streaming users,we will need one month and then we will need 3 weeks more to build up a manual of the questionnaire session and to create the questions which will be asked to the samples.
Questionnaire	Ration,sampling and data collection will take a minimum two months. It will depend on how quickly the responses arrive and can be recorded.
Interview	This will take one month to select the musicians and go to them for an interview. These data will also be recorded safely.
Focus Group Discussion	Right after the interview this session will take place. It will take two weeks to complete the discussion.
Data Collecting and Final Report	Another one month will be needed to finalize the report.
Total	**6 months 3 weeks**

3.4 Budgeting

Content Analysis	Tk 10000.00 to collect the documents and analyze them in the proper way.
Survey	Tk 15000.00 will be needed to conduct the survey.
Questionnaire	Tk 20000.00 will be required to reach the samples which will include the transportation cost.
Interview	This will need tk 30000.00 as we have to offer some refreshments to the musicians on each interview.

Focus Group Discussion	Tk 25000.00 for this session which will include the venue charge,food and logistic costs and equipment.
Miscellaneous	Tk 30000.00 for emergency fund in case of any inconvenience .
Total	**Tk 1,50,000.00**

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